



NEWSLETTER

August 2024

Kerala has around 5600 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

www.startupmission.kerala.gov.in

ROBOTICS ROUND TABLE



'Robotics Round Table' conference organised by Kerala State Industrial Development Corporation (KSIDC) partnering with Kerala Startup Mission was held at Grand Hyatt in Bolgatty Island.

Inaugurating the conference Minister for Industries, Law and Coir P. Rajeev emphasized that the expansion of new-age technologies is driving the growth of allied sectors, many of which will soon require robots to perform essential tasks. The event was part of the government's ongoing efforts to position Kerala at the forefront of technological advancements.

The Minister also noted Kerala's strong foundation in the digital sector, citing the state's achievements in e-governance, digitized banking, and widespread mobile internet connectivity.

The event drew participation from 195 startups and over 400 delegates. These events reflect Kerala's continued dedication to fostering innovation and investment within the state's growing technology sector.



HUDDLE GLOBAL ROADSHOW

The Huddle Global Roadshow has been an exhilarating journey, and we at KSUM are thrilled with its success! Each stop in Kochi, Trivandrum, and Calicut provided a unique experience, offering a glimpse into the exciting opportunities Huddle Global 2024 will bring. Startup founders shared their insights and experiences, inspiring aspiring entrepreneurs to take bold steps forward. Participants had the chance to connect with industry leaders, network with peers, and showcase their innovative ideas. Huddle Global 2024 is all about turning ideas into reality, making it a must-attend event for anyone eager to grow in the startup ecosystem.



FOUNDERS MEET 22.0 AT INKER ROBOTIC SOLUTIONS PVT LTD, THRISSUR

The 22nd edition of the Founders Meet, held at Inker Robotic Solutions Pvt Ltd in Thrissur, was a remarkable gathering of startup founders who came together to exchange ideas and insights on the evolving landscape of technology and entrepreneurship.

Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of Kerala Startup Mission, led the discussions, emphasizing the crucial role of innovation in driving the future of Kerala's startup ecosystem. He was joined by a lineup of distinguished speakers, including Rahul P Balachandran, Founder of Inker Robotics; Harikrishnan Vasudevan, Partner at R Rajan Associates; Safil Sunny, Founder & CEO of Tranzmeo; and Jobin Jose, Co-founder and CEO, alongside Jismi A. I., Co-founder and CTO of Jobin & Jismi IT Services Pvt Ltd.



LEAP CENTER INAUGURATION

INEST, DR.MOOPEN'S MEDICAL COLLEGE WAYANAD



New LEAP Co-Works Centres were inaugurated on August 30, 2024, at Adi Shankara Institute of Engineering & Technology, Kalady, and Al-Ameen College, Edathala, Aluva. The inauguration ceremonies, led by Shri Anoop Ambika, CEO of KSUM, underscored the organization's continued dedication to fostering a thriving startup ecosystem.

These new LEAP Co-Works Centres are strategically designed to provide startups and students with affordable working space, essential resources, expert mentorship, and a collaborative atmosphere to fuel their growth and innovation.

LEAP Co-Works Centres Inauguration at Adi Shankara Institute of Engineering & Technology, Kalady, and Al-Ameen College, Edathala, Aluva



Adi Shankara Institute of Engineering & Technology



Al-Ameen College, Edathala, Aluva



FAB ACADEMY GRADUATION

On August 6th, in Kochi, Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) celebrated the remarkable achievements of the Fab Academy 2024 graduates at the Fab Academy Graduation Ceremony. This prestigious, globally-recognized, six-month intensive course, organized by the Fab Foundation and led by Neil Gershenfeld, Director of MIT's Center for Bits and Atoms, provided participants with hands-on learning experiences in digital fabrication.

Throughout the course, participants engaged in advanced project design and prototyping, with additional expert sessions from distinguished professionals around the world. Graduates of Fab Academy 2024 are now well-equipped to pursue a wide range of career opportunities, including roles in product development and design, positions at Fab Labs worldwide, and research opportunities at renowned institutions like IITs. They also have the chance to collaborate on projects with MIT and the Fab Foundation, and can explore internships and fellowships at Fab Lab Kerala, further enhancing their skills and expanding their professional networks.



JAPAN DELEGATION



On August 5, 2024, Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) hosted the Indo-Japanese Academic Exchange Programme, fostering cross-cultural learning and innovation. The event welcomed delegates, including students and teachers from St. Teresa's College, Ernakulam, offering an enriching experience centered on knowledge exchange and technological exploration.

The delegates were introduced to cutting-edge technologies and the vibrant maker culture that drives innovation at KSUM. The program successfully provided the Indo-Japanese participants with a unique perspective on the integration of technology and education, reinforcing the importance of global collaboration in academic and entrepreneurial pursuits.



KERALA STARTUP MISSION & NATIONAL CADET CORPS (NCC) PARTNERSHIP

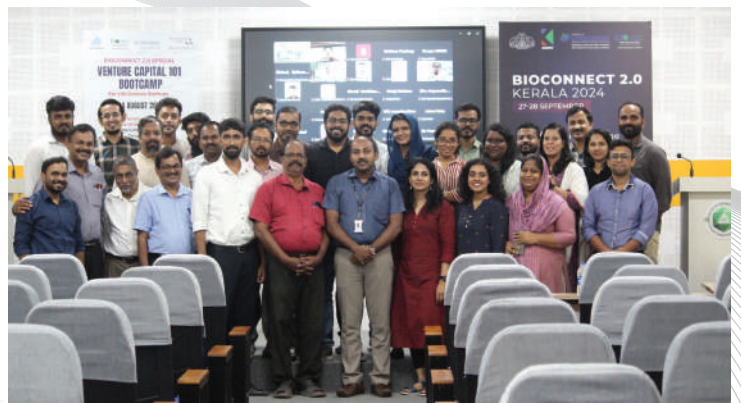
Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) has joined hands with the National Cadet Corps (NCC) to promote innovation and entrepreneurship among cadets. As part of this exciting collaboration, the NCC team, KSUM office and Fab Lab at Trivandrum to gain deeper insights into the startup ecosystem we foster. During their visit, they explored the innovative initiatives and advanced technologies that KSUM offers to budding entrepreneurs. The tour of the Fab Lab showcased the state-of-the-art resources available to startups, highlighting how these tools can empower cadets to transform their entrepreneurial ideas into reality. This collaboration aims to empower cadets to become future entrepreneurs by providing them with mentorship, resources, and opportunities, ensuring a strong foundation for their entrepreneurial ventures.





LIFE SCIENCE STARTUP EXCLUSIVE ONE-DAY BOOTCAMP ON FUNDRAISE STRATEGIES

50+ life science entrepreneurs gained invaluable insights on fundraising, valuation, and attracting investors at the recent VC 101 Bootcamp co-hosted with Bio 360 Life Science Park. The event featured experts like Dr. Praveen (KLIP CEO), Mr. G. Unnikrishnan (KSIDC), and Mr. Sunil Cavale (Speciale Invest), empowering startups to navigate the VC landscape with confidence. The bootcamp also featured inspiring success stories from Mr. Vishnu MS, Founder & CEO of Evelabs, and Dr. Lini Basil from ByLin Medtech Pvt Ltd



CONFERENCE ON INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS- IPR FOR ENTREPRENEURIAL GROWTH

The Kerala State Conference on Intellectual Property Rights, focusing on entrepreneurial growth, was held on August 8, 2024, at Kerala Startup Mission, Kochi. Organized by the Consortium of Women Entrepreneurs of India (CWEI), the event aimed to highlight the critical role of intellectual property (IP) in fostering innovation and supporting entrepreneurship. The program commenced at 10:30 AM with an inaugural session featuring a welcome address from the Kerala Startup Mission, followed by key insights from Dr. Shashi Singh, Chairperson of CWEI, and a keynote address by Mr. John Cabeca, United States Intellectual Property Counselor for South Asia.



Throughout the day, various technical sessions were held, beginning with an overview of intellectual property by Dr. R. Bhanumathi, Deputy Controller of Patents & Designs, and discussions on Geographical Indications (GI), trademark, and copyright laws. Industry experts like Ms. Shilpi Jha and Dr. Ambily K.K. provided valuable inputs on the practical aspects of IP rights in different sectors such as marine, MSMEs, and handicrafts.

The conference also featured presentations on support services for startups and MSMEs by representatives from SIDBI, Kudumbashree, and the Directorate of Fisheries. The event concluded with a live design show and certificate distribution, providing participants with actionable knowledge on leveraging IP for business growth.

WEB 3- EMPOWERING KERALA WITH BLOCKCHAIN

The "Empowering Kerala with Blockchain" conference, put together by Web3Kerala, happened on August 17, 2024, at Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), Kochi. This one-day event was all about looking into the current scene and future possibilities of Web3 technologies in Kerala. It pulled in a lively crowd of over 250 people, including developers, entrepreneurs, and industry leaders, all excited to dive into the game-changing power of blockchain.

The conference featured a series of expert talks that provided deep insights into the evolving landscape of Web3, delivered by pioneers shaping the future of this technology.

Panel discussions followed, where founders and developers shared their experiences and visions, fostering engaging conversations on the possibilities and challenges ahead. Hands-on workshops were also a key highlight, focusing on Layer 2 solutions that drive innovation and adoption in the blockchain space. Attendees had the opportunity to network, collaborate, and discover new market opportunities in Kerala's thriving Web3 economy. The event provided a platform for connecting with skilled developers and potential collaborators, making it a significant step towards advancing the Web3 ecosystem in the region.



MASTERCLASS ON HOW TO 10X YOUR REVENUE WITH ZERO COST MARKETING

On August 31, 2024, Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) in Kochi hosted a Masterclass with Mani Karthik, a growth hacker known for his success with SaaS brands like Dukaan and HappyFox. The session, aimed at startup founders, covered zero-cost marketing strategies, including the latest SEO techniques, content marketing tools, and proven growth formulas. Participants also received hands-on website health checks and engaged in a live Q&A. The event provided practical insights for founders to boost revenue without significant expenses, emphasizing innovative marketing approaches crucial for startup success.



MENTORSHIP STATS

10

MENTORS ONBOARDED

08

STARTUPS

05

MENTORS

10

INTERACTIONS



IEDC PROJECT OF THE MONTH



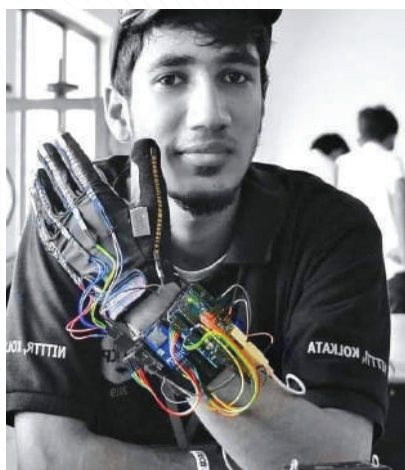
Vimun A

Vimun A's journey into innovative technology began in 2019 when he encountered a speech-impaired man at the Government Polytechnic College in Palakkad. This pivotal moment inspired him to develop a smart glove that could translate hand gestures into voice, offering a means of communication for those who cannot speak.

Three years later, after transferring to the Government Engineering College, Bartonhill, Thiruvananthapuram, through lateral entry, Vimun continued refining his idea. He has since developed a prototype of the device, now named "Gestalk." Demonstrating its capabilities, he donned wired white gloves fitted with sensors and made complex hand gestures, which were instantly translated into voice messages.

"Our five fingers can generate 120 distinct gestures that are pre-trained and translated into voice messages. Sensors on each finger capture the gestures, which are sent to a controller. The controller then converts them into voice messages in the selected regional language, delivered through a speaker. This technology not only assists the





speech-impaired but also allows paralyzed individuals to communicate with minimal gestures,” Vimun explained. The device has been successfully tested with paralyzed patients.

He plans to launch the product within six months under his company, Redfox Robotics. The current version of the glove will evolve into a more streamlined design, consisting of five rings and a smart wristband. Prices will range from ₹5,000 to ₹1.10 lakh, depending on features and customization. Additionally, Vimun envisions the device as a learning aid, especially in special schools.

A student at the Government Engineering College, Bartonhill, Vimun is not only driven by a passion for technical innovation but also holds a world record for participating in the maximum number of technical competitions in engineering. His achievements include two Grandmaster titles in the Asia Book of Records for secur-

ing the highest number of national and state-level technical awards in engineering.

His current project, the Gestalk glove, focuses on translating hand gestures into voice, text, and images, with the aim of empowering both paralyzed patients and the mute community. Through his work, Vimun is dedicated to bridging the gap between technology and human needs, ensuring that communication is accessible to all, regardless of physical limitations.

RINK TECHNOLOGY CORNER

Name of the Technology : [National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology \(CSIR-NIIST\)](#)

About the Technology : Process for continuous / batch wise washing, cleaning, waxing, grading & drying of fresh ginger. The process results in value added & shelf life enhanced fresh ginger for the global market.

Salient features of Technology : The key operations involved are continuous cleaning / washing of fresh ginger for removal of adhering mud, sorting for bigger and smaller sized ginger, size reduction and mechanical dewatering for smaller ginger followed by drying & powdering for making ginger powder. The big size ginger will undergo waxing (optional), drying for market as superior grade.



Equipment, machinery and other facilities : Custom made design for batch/ continuous model of washing, cleaning , waxing, drying units, mechanical drier, dejuicer, slicer, hammer mill, micro pulverizer etc.

For more details, Write to: rink@startupmission.in



GOVERNMENT AS A MARKETPLACE

Technical Committee Evaluation

The technical committee for Startup Procurement held a meeting on September 3rd to evaluate the following project

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Kerala Police - Police Training College	Learning Management System	Netventure Digital Solutions Private Limited	7.86
02	Kudumbashree State Mission	Develop an Android Mobile Application and software for the Urban Poverty Reduction Plan(UPRP)	Travidux Technologies Private Limited	7.5
03	Kerala State Electricity Board Limited	Development of Telephone Directory application	Travidux Technologies Private Limited	3.5
04	kerala Artisans' Development corporation (KADCO)	Development of Web Application for KADCO	COLLABORATIVE LEARNING LABS Private Limited	5.6
05	Kerala State Cashew Development Corporation Limited	Marketing and Branding for KSCDC	Bridging Dots Media Solutions Private Limited	12

AUGUST - SEPTEMBER 03

No of EOIs	4
Project Under Evaluation	11
Projects Approved	5
Value of work orders(in Lakhs)	36.46
Active EOIs	2

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Have a thought, comment or suggestion to share with us?

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